Vivo V80

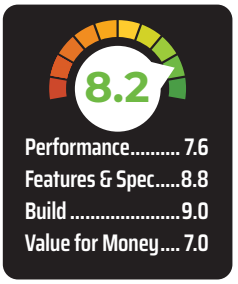
Another Zeiss-Vivo camera win

There was a time when buying a smartphone in the Rs 60,000 to Rs 80,000 range was mostly about getting the fastest chip or the most premium design. That has changed. Cameras have become one of the biggest reasons people spend this much on a phone, and almost every brand now has a camera-focused offering in this segment. People want punchy colours, crisp details that look good on social media, and enough processing options to make their photos stand out without having to edit them for hours. Add decent performance, a good design, and a quality display to that, and you have a combination that is difficult to ignore.

₹62,999



But there is a bigger issue creeping into the smartphone market right now, and it is becoming increasingly difficult to ignore: prices are going up, and they are going up by a lot. Vivo's V-series has traditionally sat in the upper mid-range segment, with the last-gen Vivo V70 starting at around Rs 45,000. The Vivo V80 starts at Rs 62,999 and goes all the way up to Rs 79,999 for the top-end variant. That is almost X-series pricing for what has historically been one of Vivo's more accessible premium smartphone line-ups.



Of course, this is not a problem specific to Vivo. Smartphone makers are dealing with rising component costs, and if things continue this way, higher prices will be the norm through 2027.

CAMERA

The camera setup is clearly one of the biggest reasons to consider the Vivo V80. The phone is equipped with a 50MP ZEISS OIS main camera using Sony's LYTIA 700V sensor, a 50MP ZEISS Night Telephoto camera with 3x optical zoom and OIS, and a ZEISS ultrawide camera. There is also a 50MP ZEISS selfie camera with autofocus and a 92-degree field of view.

Starting with the main camera, the Vivo V80 has a noticeably warm and punchy colour profile. It does boost saturation slightly, but that is not necessarily a bad thing. Photos have the kind of vibrant look that works well for social media without making colours completely unnatural. Vivo's ZEISS tuning seems to be aimed at making images look attractive straight out of the camera rather than chasing absolute colour accuracy.

Dynamic range is another strong point. The camera does a good job balancing bright skies with darker areas in mixed lighting, while backlit subjects generally retain usable detail. I also found highlight handling impressive on reflective and metallic surfaces. Bright reflections are controlled well enough that details, textures, and even branding remain visible instead of simply turning into blown-out patches.

Close-up photography is particularly good. The main sensor resolves fine textures well, with crisp edges and soft background separation. This gives macro-style shots a pleasing amount of depth without making the background blur look excessively artificial.

The 50MP telephoto lens comes with 3x optical zoom; useful for portraits and distant subjects, while the higher resolution gives you room to push towards 10x without losing all the detail. At longer digital zoom ranges, however, some softness inevitably creeps in.

The ultrawide camera is decent, although it does not quite match the main camera for detail and rendering. There is some softness towards the corners and the overall image looks flatter, but distortion around straight lines and subjects is controlled well.

Low-light photography is where the Vivo V80 surprised me. Noise remains well controlled at moderate ISOs, and instead of producing the blotchy look that some phones get when aggressively processing night shots, the V80 retains a clean and natural appearance.

I also like how Vivo handles shadows at night. The V80 does not aggressively lift every dark area just to make the image brighter. Shadows retain their natural depth, while wet surfaces, reflections, and artificial lights maintain good colour separation. The result is a low-light image that looks closer to the scene I actually saw rather than an overly processed night-mode photo.

Portrait photography follows the same philosophy. Background blur is smooth, while edge detection around hair and other fine details is generally accurate. Skin tones have a warm, flat-